

**BOROUGH OF MOUNTAINSIDE**

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To: Softball League Participants
From: Frank Masella, Director, Mountainside Recreation Department
Subject: Softball League Rule Updates – Effective Immediately

Based on feedback received over the past year, the following updates to the softball league rules and procedures will take effect immediately.

Rosters

- Team rosters will remain capped at **15 players** for the summer season (additional players may be added only if other teams are full).
 - Teams may roster a maximum of **three out-of-town players**.
 - Players who work for Mountainside (Police, DPW, Boro Admin) will be considered residents.
 - Players will no longer be permitted to freely switch teams. Returning players may either:
 - Remain on their current team, or
 - Enter a **free agency draft pool**, which will go in order of last season's reverse standings (regular season + playoff records).
 - **Exemptions from the free agency pool** apply only to:
 - Immediate family members (defined as father, son, or brother), and
 - Out-of-town players.
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Playing Rules

- A defined **batter's box** will be used; at least **one foot must remain in the box** throughout the at-bat.
 - **No vocal or visual distractions** are permitted during the pitch.
 - **Zero tolerance** for unsportsmanlike conduct, including arguing with umpires or opposing players.
 - Only the captain can talk with the umpire regarding a rules interpretation only; judgment calls will not be argued by anyone.
 - **Deerfield Fall League ground rule:** A ball that passes through the center field gap will be ruled a **ground-rule triple**.
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Schedule & Fees

- **23-game regular season**, followed by a **double-elimination playoff**.
- **Opening Day:** April 26
 - All teams will play.
 - Umpire fees will be split between teams.
- Each team will play **one doubleheader per week for 11 weeks**.
- Game times: **7:45 PM and 8:45 PM**.
- Rainouts will be **automatically rescheduled** for the next available Sunday.
- **Umpire fees:** \$70 per game, paid by the home team
 - *Exception:* Opening Day and playoff games, where fees will be split.

- Players must participate in **at least 8 games** to be eligible for the playoffs.
- The **estimated league registration fee** is expected to increase to approximately **\$70 per player** (umpire fees not included).

Thank you for your cooperation as we continue to improve the league experience.



Frank Masella
Recreation Director
Mountainside Recreation Department